The 6:15

WEDNESDAY · OCTOBER 7, 2026 NO. 24

THE BOARD

CALENDAR · NEXT 10 DAYS

Wed 10/7, 8:00p	Yankees host Rays, ALDS Gm 3 — face elimination down 0-2 (truTV, Yankee Stadium); not yet played
Thu 10/8	Knicks preseason home opener vs. Washington, MSG
Sat 10/10	Northwestern hosts Ball State, Homecoming, Ryan Field
Tue 10/13	Q3 earnings: JPMorgan, Citigroup, Goldman Sachs, all before the open
Wed 10/14, 8:30a	September CPI (BLS), no consensus located **[flag]**; also BofA, Morgan Stanley Q3
Thu 10/15	September PPI; U.S. Bancorp Q3; ~48 cos. report this week overall, only banks above verified **[flag]**
Oct 27-28	FOMC — hike odds 16%, flat vs. Monday's 17%; Dec. 9 hike odds firmed to 73% from ~65%

Standing: Dec. 11 CR funds gov't, no shutdown risk through Election Day [continuity]. US-China truce to Jan. 10 unchanged [continuity]. No frontier-AI release or rocket launch verified this run. OpenAI reportedly closed a $6.6B round at a $157B valuation in recent days (see Business) — exact date and primary confirmation not located this run **[NEW, flag]**.

METRICS · ET UNLESS NOTED

Brent (Dec. ICE)	$101.83 (+1.24% vs. Mon. $100.58 settle), ~5:50a **[straits.live reads $100.87, flag]**
WTI (NYMEX)	$89.87 (+0.48%), no settle yet, range $89.36–90.58, ~6:06a. Spread ~$12.0
2Y / 10Y / 30Y	4.804% (+0.27%) / 5.321% (+1.01%) / 5.702% (+1.08%, near 52-wk high), ~6:00-6:20a
DXY (Dec. fut.)	102.078 (+0.47%), ~6:13a
S&P / Nasdaq fut.	ESZ26 7,865.00 (-0.11%) / NQ 31,360.75 (-0.39%), delayed, ~5:36-6:03a
VIX	15.55 (+3.60%), ~6:17a

Gold (Dec. fut.)	$4,141.22 (-1.10% vs. $4,187.10 prior close), ~6:18a
Asia / Europe	Nikkei closed -0.76% (70,150.00); Hang Seng closed -0.62% (24,130.50); FTSE 10,491.62 (-0.47%), DAX 25,149.36 (-1.18%), both intraday
Retail gas (AAA)	$4.3667/gal, as of 10/7/26

HORMUZ COUNTERS

Transits	4 vessels (Oct. 4) vs. 85/day baseline (straits.live) **[flag, lagged]**
Holding (AIS)	151 ships, ~6:17a — down from 191 Monday; treated as noise
Dark tankers (24h)	76 of 195 screened vs. 87.9 5-day avg. — first sub-baseline read in recent issues **[flag]**
Strikes (24h / running)	On Peace hit Tue. 10/6, 12 of 19 crew injured — worst casualty toll of the war **[NEW]**; 63 total indexed incidents in 24h **[flag, single-sourced]**
War-risk premia	~$10.0M/VLCC transit, ~30x pre-crisis — flat vs. issue No. 23
Closures	"Closed" per straits.live/Iran; FT reports $100k/month pilot premiums to transit anyway — contested **[flag]**

Crisis Pressure "extreme," Escalation Forecast "elevated," both flat 24h — reverted to qualitative bands, second format flip in two issues [flag]. Methodology: transit counts (lagged), AIS counts (same-day, volatile) and war-risk premia (stale, periodic) measure different things over different windows; never averaged or differenced here.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees	Face elimination tonight, Gm 3 vs. Rays, 8:00p ET — not yet played
Knicks	No game since Mon.'s 97-120 loss at Philadelphia; host Washington Thu. (home opener)
Northwestern	No game since Sat.'s 34-13 win over Penn State; hosts Ball State Sat. (Homecoming)

LEAD

A WARTIME FIRST, AND OIL TALKS BACK

Hormuz's deadliest strike of the war sends oil back above $101, unwinding Monday's divergence — and splitting the bond market into two stories at once

The Strait of Hormuz campaign recorded its worst casualty toll since the war began Feb. 28: the LR2 tanker *On Peace* was struck by an unidentified projectile Tuesday, injuring 12 of its 19 crew — 11 of them Indian nationals — with Oman's military airlifting 10 to hospital. It came two days after the Greek-flagged LNG carrier *Maran Gas Mystras* was hit near the waterline Sunday while leaving the strait; its 30-member crew was unhurt and the ship continued under its own power toward Fujairah. UKMTO has logged at least one attack a day in the strait or the Gulf of Aden since Oct. 2 and holds its threat assessment at "severe"; no attribution has been made for either strike.

Crude reversed hard on the news. Brent's December ICE contract traded at $101.83 as of 5:50a ET, up 1.24% against Monday's $100.58 settle; WTI was at $89.87, up 0.48%, with no settle yet. That is the mirror image of Monday's pattern: issue No. 23 of this brief reported both benchmarks falling even as UKMTO disclosed four separate tanker strikes, because Mideast exports were topping pre-war levels on four of the prior seven days and Saudi Aramco had just deepened its November Asian discount. The decoupling didn't survive a second consecutive day of escalation, now with the war's first double-digit casualty count — oil is pricing the headline again, not the flow data, and the flow data hasn't actually updated: straits.live's board still has transits frozen at four vessels on Oct. 4 against an 85/day baseline, lagging as it has for days. Oddly, the same dashboard's dark-tanker screen — vessels running AIS-dark to

dodge the war-risk premium — came in at 76 of 195 ships screened, below its own 87.9 five-day average for the first time in recent issues, though the operator itself cautions the number is "a floor on hulls we stopped receiving, not a verified evasion tally." War-risk premia held flat at roughly $10 million per VLCC transit, about 30 times the pre-crisis rate.

The oil move dragged rates with it. The 10-year rose to 5.321% (+1.01%) and the 30-year to 5.702%, within a point of its 52-week high, both climbing across the same stretch of the morning that Brent did. That's the second-order consequence worth sitting with: Friday's payrolls miss put the Fed's Oct. 28 decision on ice — hike odds sit at 16%, barely changed from Monday's 17% — but an oil-driven pop in headline inflation expectations is now pulling the long end up even as the front end stays anchored to a dovish read on the Fed, a steepening dynamic that wasn't present Monday. December hike odds, meanwhile, firmed to 73% from roughly 65% two sessions ago — consistent with a market pricing the tightening case back in for year-end precisely because oil has stopped cooperating with the disinflation story. Equities are taking note: Tuesday's record S&P and Nasdaq closes gave way to red futures this morning (S&P -0.11%, Nasdaq 100 -0.39%) as the MSCI Asia-Pacific complex fell on tech weakness in South Korea and Hong Kong (Nikkei -0.76%, Hang Seng -0.62% at the close), with Europe following lower (FTSE -0.47%, DAX -1.18% intraday).

None of this resolves the diplomatic track. Qatari mediators met Iranian FM Araghchi in New York Monday to relay a US counter-offer to Tehran's seven-day reopening plan; Trump has called the original proposal "unacceptable," and Iran says the strait stays shut "until the US meets its conditions." No outcome from the New York

channel is confirmed as of writing. The question for the rest of the week is whether Oct. 14's CPI print, rather than Friday's jobs report, ends up being the data point that decides whether the Fed's October hold survives contact with an oil market that just stopped playing along.

POLITICS

Generic-ballot polling continues to show a Democratic edge heading into next month's midterms, though with real dispersion across pollsters: Emerson has it at D+11, Fox News at D+8, while YouGov's latest put it at just D+2 — its smallest Democratic margin since September. Composite trackers (Silver Bulletin, plusminus4) put the average in the mid-D+5-to-6 range, little changed from where it has sat for weeks — the dispersion is new, the center of gravity isn't. No state primary or special-election result was confirmed for Oct. 6. The September CR funding the government through Dec. 11 remains the operative fact keeping a shutdown off the table through Election Day.

ECONOMICS

Friday's payrolls miss (Lead) remains the data point setting the Fed's near-term path; Oct. 14 CPI and Oct. 15 PPI are next, with no consensus for either located this run. The swing factor the Lead flags — an oil-driven pop in the 10- and 30-year even as short-dated hike odds sit at a cycle-low 16% — means this week's bank earnings (JPMorgan, Citigroup and Goldman Sachs report Oct. 13; Bank of America and Morgan Stanley Oct. 14) will be read as much for net-interest-margin and credit commentary against a steepening curve as

for the headline results. September's ISM manufacturing miss, flagged in issues No. 22 and 23, is dropped here as unmoved.

BUSINESS

OpenAI closed a $6.6 billion funding round at a $157 billion valuation, led by Thrive Capital with a $1.3 billion check; Microsoft added $750 million, bringing its total stake past $14 billion, while Nvidia, SoftBank ($500 million) and Abu Dhabi's MGX also participated, alongside Fidelity, Tiger Global, Altimeter, Coatue and Khosla Ventures. (Reported via multiple secondary outlets — TechSpot, Forbes Australia, Benzinga, Gulf News — not cross-verified against OpenAI's own statement this run.) The round reportedly makes OpenAI one of the three largest venture-backed companies by capital raised, alongside SpaceX and ByteDance. No exact closing date was confirmed this run. The Oct. 12-16 earnings cluster (~48 companies per Nasdaq's calendar) is otherwise led by the banks above (Economics); no individual non-bank names were independently verified this run.

IRAN & HORMUZ

The casualty count above sits alongside a broader incident count: straits.live's chronology logged 63 total indexed events in the 24 hours to this morning, a figure the operator itself flags as single-sourced. UKMTO's southern transit corridor remains open to two-way traffic even as the agency holds its threat assessment at "severe"; the dashboard's own closure read is "closed to commercial shipping due to war-risk insurance" as of 6:17a, but that status is contested on the ground — Iran maintains the strait stays shut until the US meets its conditions, while the Financial Times reports captains are being paid $100,000 a month to transit anyway. Crisis Pressure reverted to a qualitative "extreme" reading and Escalation Forecast to "elevated," both flat over 24 hours — the second format flip in as many issues (numeric 88/100 and 58/100 in issue No. 23, qualitative bands before and now again), which this brief treats as a vendor-side inconsistency rather than a real signal.

Diplomatically, nothing has moved past what the Lead describes: Qatari mediators carried a US counter-offer to Araghchi in New York Monday; no text or outcome has been confirmed. Transits remain frozen at the straits.live board's last recorded reading of four vessels on Oct. 4 against an 85/day pre-crisis baseline — the feed still hasn't posted a newer day — while AIS-visible vessels holding position stand at 151, down from 191 Monday but within the recent 89-285 range this brief treats as noise rather than trend. Taken together: the attack rate and its severity are both rising, the physical-flow data is too stale to say whether exports are still outrunning the strike count the way they were through Monday, and this morning's oil move is a

bet that the casualty headline matters more than the stale transit print — at least until straits.live's feed catches up.

SPORTS

Yankees	Host Rays tonight, Gm 3, 8:00p ET, Yankee Stadium (truTV) — face elimination down 0-2; not yet played as of writing.
Knicks	No game since Monday's 97-120 preseason-opener loss at Philadelphia; host Washington Thu. 10/8, MSG (home opener).
Northwestern	Beat Penn State 34-13 Saturday; 3-1 overall, 1-1 Big Ten; hosts Ball State Sat. 10/10 (Homecoming).

Continuity. Cut from issue No. 23 as unmoved: the single NBC generic-ballot callout (superseded by today's cross-pollster dispersion read); ISM manufacturing's September miss (third issue running, now dropped); Technology and Geopolitics sections (no new frontier-AI release, rocket launch, or confirmed Ukraine/OPEC+ development this run — skipped rather than padded).

Unverified figures are marked in red. OpenAI's $6.6B/$157B round is multi-source secondary reporting, not cross-verified against OpenAI's own statement; CPI/PPI consensus for Oct. 14/15 not located; straits.live's 63-incident count and Crisis Pressure/Escalation Forecast bands are single-sourced; no Brent/WTI settle this morning; DXY and gold quotes are December futures, not spot; the generic-ballot composite is aggregator-derived. Nothing else was estimated or filled from memory.